

1. Governance StructStructuring Limye's Leadership for Founder Control

This document outlines a recommended organizational structure for Limye' to ensure the founder maintains control while establishing robust governance and operational frameworks.1. Governance Structure (Board of Directors)

Purpose: To oversee mission, strategy, and fiscal accountability while allowing the founder to retain ultimate control.

Recommended Model:

- **Board Size:** 5–7 members (smaller boards are easier to manage and align with the founder's vision).
- **Roles:**
 - **Chair:** The founder (to retain decision-making authority).
 - **Vice Chair:** A trusted advisor (e.g., legal/finance expert).
 - **Treasurer:** For financial oversight.
 - **Secretary:** For compliance and record-keeping.
 - **2–3 At-Large Members:** Community leaders or subject-matter experts (e.g., healthcare, logistics).

Key Controls for the Founder:

- **Founder Voting Rights:** Include bylaws granting the founder veto power over critical decisions (e.g., mergers, dissolution).
- **Staggered Terms:** Rotate board terms (e.g., 2–3 years) to prevent sudden power shifts.
- **Advisory Council:** Add a non-voting advisory group for input without diluting board control.

2. Executive Leadership (Day-to-Day Control)

Purpose: To execute operations while the founder maintains strategic direction.

Recommended Roles:

- **Chief Executive Officer (CEO):** The founder (to retain ultimate authority).
- **Chief Operating Officer (COO):** Hire an experienced operations leader to manage programs (e.g., Non-Emergency Medical Transportation (NEMT), nutrition services).
- **Chief Financial Officer (CFO):** Initially outsourced or part-time to manage grants/contracts.
- **Department Directors:** Report to the CEO/COO (e.g., Healthcare, Transportation, Youth Services).

Key Controls for the Founder:

- **Direct Reports:** Ensure all department heads report directly to the founder or the COO.
- **Approval Thresholds:** Require the founder's sign-off for budgets exceeding a specific amount or major hires.

3. For-Profit Subsidiaries (Retaining Ownership)

Purpose: To generate revenue for the nonprofit while keeping control.

Structure:

- Limye' Transportation LLC (NEMT)
- Limye' Foods LLC (meal services)
- Limye' Properties LLC (real estate)

Key Controls for the Founder:

- **Ownership:** The nonprofit's founder should hold 51%+ ownership in each subsidiary.
- **Board Seats:** The founder plus 1–2 nonprofit board members sit on subsidiary boards.
- **Profit Reinvestment:** Require subsidiaries to direct profits back to the nonprofit.

4. Checks and Balances (Without Losing Control)

- **Bylaws:** Draft bylaws specifying:
 - The founder's permanent role as Board Chair/CEO.
 - Limits on the board's power to remove the founder without cause.
 - Profit distribution rules from subsidiaries.
- **Advisory Committees:** Use committees (e.g., Finance, Program) to involve stakeholders without voting rights.
- **Succession Plan:** Define a founder-led succession process (e.g., family member or appointed successor).

Example from Your Documents

The NEMT Workforce Plan emphasizes mission-driven staff, and the Service Blueprint outlines integrated services. The leadership structure should align similarly:

- The founder as CEO/Board Chair controls strategy.
- The COO manages operations (e.g., NEMT, nutrition).
- The Board approves budgets, but the founder sets priorities.

Key Recommendations

- **Start Small:** Begin with a 5-person board (the founder + 4 trusted allies).
- **Legal Safeguards:** Work with a nonprofit attorney to draft founder-friendly bylaws.
- **Hybrid Control:** Use subsidiaries to generate revenue but keep ownership under the nonprofit (and the founder).

- **Document Everything:** Clearly define roles in bylaws and operating agreements.

ure (Board of Directors)

Purpose: Oversee mission, strategy, and fiscal accountability while allowing you to retain control.

Recommended Model:

Board Size: 5–7 members (smaller boards are easier to manage and align with your vision).

Roles:

Chair: You (founder) to retain decision-making authority.

Vice Chair: Trusted advisor (e.g., legal/finance expert).

Treasurer: Financial oversight.

Secretary: Compliance/record-keeping.

2–3 At-Large Members: Community leaders or subject-matter experts (e.g., healthcare, logistics).

Key Controls for You:

Founder Voting Rights: Include bylaws granting you veto power over critical decisions (e.g., mergers, dissolution).

Staggered Terms: Rotate board terms (e.g., 2–3 years) to prevent sudden power shifts.

Advisory Council: Add a non-voting advisory group for input without diluting board control.

2. Executive Leadership (Day-to-Day Control)

Purpose: Execute operations while you maintain strategic direction.

Recommended Roles:

Chief Executive Officer (CEO): You (founder) to retain ultimate authority.

Chief Operating Officer (COO): Hire an experienced ops leader to manage programs (e.g., NEMT, nutrition services).

Chief Financial Officer (CFO): Outsourced or part-time initially to manage grants/contracts.

Department Directors: Report to you/COO (e.g., Healthcare, Transportation, Youth Services).

Key Controls for You:

Direct Reports: Ensure all department heads report to you or your COO.

Approval Thresholds: Require your sign-off for budgets >\$X or major hires.

3. For-Profit Subsidiaries (Retaining Ownership)

Purpose: Generate revenue for the nonprofit while keeping control.

Structure:

Limye' Transportation LLC (NEMT)

Limye' Foods LLC (meal services)

Limye' Properties LLC (real estate)

Key Controls for You:

Ownership: Hold 51%+ ownership in each subsidiary as the nonprofit's founder.

Board Seats: You + 1–2 nonprofit board members sit on subsidiary boards.

Profit Reinvestment: Require subsidiaries to direct profits back to the nonprofit.

4. Checks and Balances (Without Losing Control)

Bylaws: Draft bylaws specifying:

Founder's permanent role as Board Chair/CEO.

Limits on board power to remove founder without cause.

Profit distribution rules from subsidiaries.

Advisory Committees: Use committees (e.g., Finance, Program) to involve stakeholders without voting rights.

Succession Plan: Define a founder-led succession process (e.g., family member or appointed successor).

Example from Your Documents

Your NEMT Workforce Plan emphasizes mission-driven staff, and the Service Blueprint outlines integrated services. Align the leadership structure similarly:

You as CEO/Board Chair control strategy.

COO manages ops (e.g., NEMT, nutrition).

Board approves budgets but you set priorities.

Key Recommendations

Start Small: Begin with a 5-person board (you + 4 trusted allies).

Legal Safeguards: Work with a nonprofit attorney to draft founder-friendly bylaws.

Hybrid Control: Use subsidiaries to generate revenue but keep ownership under the nonprofit (and you).

Document Everything: Clearly define roles in bylaws/operating agreements.